

Defining the Problem: Persona & Jobs-to-be-Done

A structured approach to understanding who your customer is, what they truly need, and how to define the problem clearly — guiding innovation with empathy and precision.

POINT-OF-VIEW PHASE

TARGET GROUP

CUSTOMER NEEDS



The Point-of-View Phase

The POV phase is the **interpretation stage** where you translate what you've learned about users into a focused perspective on their needs, pains, and goals. It defines **whose** problem you're solving, **what** the problem is, and **why** it matters.

Creates Distance

Places the user in a hypothetical profile, reducing innovator bias and bringing teams closer to customer reality.

Encourages Empathy

The customer is no longer "anonymous" — they become a relatable character with real frustrations and desires.

Aligns Innovation

Helps teams align solutions with actual customer needs rather than assumptions or technology-driven ideas.



POV Statement: The Three Key Elements

Together, these three elements form a concise, empathetic problem definition that guides ideation and keeps solutions human-centered.

User — Who

The persona or target group you're focusing on.

"Anna, a busy marketing manager who values simplicity."

Need — What

The core challenge or desire.

"Needs a faster way to manage campaign data without technical complexity."

Insight — Why

The underlying motivation or frustration.

"Feels overwhelmed by tools that require constant updates and manual inputs."

Sample POV Statement: "Anna needs a simple, intuitive campaign dashboard because she wants to focus on creativity, not data maintenance."

Point-of-View Phase

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Defining the Problem



Sample POV Statement:

“Anna needs a simple, intuitive campaign dashboard because she wants to focus on creativity, not data maintenance. ”

Characterisation of the Target Group

Build **different personas** — not averages. Describe each holistically: demographics, occupation, lifestyle, attitudes, hobbies, media use, and consumption habits. Use a motto or quotation to bring the persona to life, and keep it to a one-page profile with keywords and short sentences.



First-Time Buyer

New to the category — needs guidance, trust signals, and clear onboarding.



Extreme User

Pushes product limits — reveals edge cases and innovation opportunities.



Negative Persona

Represents who you're *not* serving — sharpens focus and prevents scope creep.



B2B Buyer Persona

Maps decision-makers, influencers, and saboteurs within an organization.

Target Group Characteristics

The target group represents the specific segment of customers your innovation is aimed at — defined by shared traits, behaviors, and motivations. A layered view helps teams see not just **who** the customer is, but **why** they act the way they do.

Demographics	Age, gender, location, occupation — e.g., "Urban professionals aged 25–40."
Psychographics	Values, interests, lifestyle — e.g., "Health-conscious, tech-savvy, values sustainability."
Behavioral Traits	Buying habits, brand loyalty, usage frequency — e.g., "Prefers premium brands, buys online monthly."
Media Habits	Channels and platforms used — e.g., "Active on Instagram and LinkedIn, reads digital news."
Pain Points	Frustrations, challenges, unmet needs — e.g., "Finds current tools too complex and time-consuming."
Gains & Motivations	Desires, goals, aspirations — e.g., "Wants to save time and feel more productive."

Here's how these characteristics connect visually:

Target Groups: B2C versus B2B		
Aspect		
Audience	End consumer (private individuals)	Business customers (companies)
Purchase cycles	Short-term, spontaneous	Long-term, planned
Purchase motives	Emotional, habitual (e.g. FMCG products)	Rational, ROI-driven
Segmentation	Demographic, psychographic, behavior-based	Industry-specific, role-based, needs-based





Persona name

Persona role

About

- Age: 27
- Location: London
- Education: Bachelor's
- Marital Status: Non-Binary
- Occupation: CEO
- Relationship: Single

Attributes: Ambitious, Assertive, Energetic, Helpful, Creative, Tech-Savvy

Motivations

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Nulla morbi vitae turpis in malesuada. Commodo ultricies viverra viverra quis amet amet. In fringilla tellus. arcu malesuada sollicitudin.

Goals

- Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.
- Arcu viverra hendrerit du vitae.
- Nunc vitae vari sed turpis ultrices facilisis tectidunt quam adipiscing.
- Nunc, orci aenean sit purus aliquam egestas augue.

Pain Points

- Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.
- Arcu viverra hendrerit du vitae.
- Nunc vitae vari sed turpis ultrices facilisis tectidunt quam adipiscing.
- Nunc, orci aenean sit purus aliquam egestas augue.

Personality

Introvert ————— Extrovert

Thinking ————— Feeling

Judging ————— Perceiving

Assertive ————— Submissive

Initiative ————— Dismissive

Technical Skills

Internet: 5/5 stars

Social Networks: 4/5 stars

Online Shopping: 3/5 stars

Brands

Google, MARVEL, TikTok, ZARA, Apple, Amazon

Description of Customer Needs

Customer needs are the motivations, problems, and desires that drive people to seek solutions — the "**why**" behind every purchase or interaction. Understanding them enables customer-centric innovation, improves product-market fit, and builds empathy and loyalty.

Pains

Frustrations, challenges, risks, fears, mistakes, and resistance — what **annoys** the customer.

Gains

Needs, desires, dreams, goals, buying motives, and expectations — what **excites** the customer.

Functional Needs

Practical or performance-based requirements. *"Needs a phone with long battery life."*

Emotional Needs

Feelings or psychological satisfaction. *"Wants to feel confident and stylish."*

Social Needs

Desire for belonging, recognition, or status. *"Buys eco-friendly products to be seen as responsible."*

Latent Needs

Unspoken or unrecognized needs that emerge through observation. *"Didn't realize they needed a smartwatch until they saw how it tracks health."*

Customer Needs

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Understanding Pains & Gains



Persona Analysis



Jobs-to-Be Done



Empathy Research



Pains & Gains Mapping

Jobs-to-be-Done Framework

The Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) concept reveals the **what** and **why** behind customer behavior — customers don't buy products; they *hire* them to get a job done. JTBD categorizes these jobs into three types:



Functional Jobs

Practical tasks the customer needs to accomplish — the core utility of a product or service.



Social Jobs

Status, prestige, and influence — how the customer wants to be perceived by others.



Personal Jobs

Emotional satisfaction, pride, and enjoyment — how the customer wants to feel.

Together, these three job types provide a complete picture of what customers truly want to achieve — not just the functional outcome, but the social and emotional dimensions that drive their decisions.

Jobs-to-Be-Done Job Mapping

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8 Steps to Success



Jobs-to-Be-Done Job Mapping



Persona Template



Photo

Name: _____

Age: _____

Motto: " _____ "



PAINS

- Pain Point 1
- Pain Point 2
- Pain Point 3
- Pain Point 4



GAINS

- Gain Point 1
- Gain Point 2
- Gain Point 3
- Gain Point 4

Background:

- Info 1
- Info 2
- Info 3

Goals & Interests:

- Info A
- Info B
- Info C

Job Mapping: The 8-Step Process

Job Mapping breaks down the complete journey a customer takes to accomplish a job — from initial recognition through resolution. Each step reveals opportunities for innovation and improvement.

1

Define

Identify and articulate the job to be done

2

Search

Look for solutions or approaches

3

Prepare

Get ready to execute the job

4

Confirm

Validate the chosen approach

5

Execute

Carry out the core task

6

Monitor

Track progress and results

7

Adapt

Adjust based on feedback

8

Close

Complete and resolve the job

Use Job Mapping alongside persona analysis, empathy interviews, and pain-gain mapping to uncover frustrations and desires at each step — revealing where solutions can create the most value.

Benefits of Persona & JTBD

Together, personas and Jobs-to-be-Done create a powerful foundation for customer-centered innovation — making teams more empathetic, aligned, and effective.



Customer Orientation

Creates a shared customer focus across all teams, even those without direct customer contact.



Cost-Effective Innovation

Makes innovation empathetic and efficient by grounding decisions in real needs rather than assumptions.



Structured Insight

Reveals what customers truly want: not products, but *solutions* to their real problems.



Builds Empathy

Helps employees understand the customer's world, fostering loyalty and better product-market fit.



Key Takeaway

Personas and Jobs-to-be-Done are complementary tools that, together, define the problem clearly and guide innovation effectively.

Personas = Who

The customer — a relatable character with demographics, psychographics, behaviors, pains, and gains. Makes the customer real, not anonymous.

Jobs-to-be-Done = What

What the customer wants to achieve — functional, social, and personal jobs mapped across an 8-step journey from Define to Close.

POV Phase = Why

Synthesizes persona and JTBD into a clear, empathetic problem statement: *User + Need + Insight* — the foundation for human-centered innovation.

 **Remember:** Customers don't buy products — they hire them to get a job done. Define the problem before designing the solution.